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die due to lack of support. Whether it's electric cars or earthen refrigerators, India's future lies in innovations.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Battle Unready

There is an urgent need to train the police and paramilitary forces to take on the Naxals using their own strategy—surprise hit-and-scoot tactics ("Lambs to the Slaughter", April 26). Our forces should be equipped with better firepower so that they can inflict great damage on the enemy when ambushed. Our communication systems should improve so that the forces can call for reinforcement immediately, if outnumbered.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

The article candidly points out inadequacies in the training of the CRPF personnel in the fight against the Maoists. It is not a lack of valour but of resources that kills them. Though the home minister said in Parliament that the Dantewada CRPF team had undergone induction training, it is clear that it was not enough and effective. The training should include good understanding of the topography of the area and the tactics and weapons used by the Maoists.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY,
Pune

Flight Failure

The non-performance of the GSLV-D3 due to a faulty cryogenic engine must make our scientists resolve to perfect the engine as early as possible, for the next launch ("Off to a Cold Start", April 26). India should be thankful to Russia for providing the Indian Space Research Organisation with cryogenic engines which enabled us to launch satellites until now.

S. LAKSHMI,
via www.indiatoday.in



VIRENDER MISHRA

“Naxalism is very correctly identified as terrorism and should be crushed with vehemence. Any dilution in the effort will give the Naxals an opportunity to increase their strength.”

DEEPESH KUMAR, *Bilaspur*

Left to Right

The Travancore Devaswom Board being targeted by the Left Democratic Government comes as no surprise ("Temple Muddle", April 19). Ideologically, they pose as anti-religion and hence it adds a different complexion. The pity is instead of prosecuting individuals,

the LDF is trying to get a foothold by resorting to reservation tactics.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

Caught Short

The shortage of officers exists not only in the IPS cadre but also in defence forces ("IPSo Facto", April 26). The Government realises its deficiency and continues to make genuine efforts in order to bring about a change. Till then the officers have to deliver to the best of

their abilities. The Home Ministry must look into the aspect of physical fitness of the officers in general and junior officers in particular. Their well-being will ensure that the troops become physically as well as mentally fit to take on miscreants.

LT-COL (RETD) RANJIT SINHA,
Kochi

Zia in Dire Straits

Like the ulcer-ridden executive who heads for the hills once the blood pressure gets too high, President Zia-ur-Rahman of Bangladesh is in the habit of timing his foreign visits when the domestic pot starts boiling over. He carefully orchestrated things so he would be the first head of state to visit India after Mrs Gandhi's return to power at a time when his domestic image needed a major lift. And now that domestic discontent is touching new highs, Zia is off to see the Queen of England and in the process, try and persuade Britain's Margaret Thatcher to increase her country's aid commitment to Bangladesh. In fact, Zia has been making some fairly desperate efforts lately to get European countries to bankroll Bangladesh's sagging economy. In Paris, last month, Bangladesh had sought an aid packet of \$2,500 million. Donor countries, however, decided to cough up only \$1,300 million.

by Dilip Bobb



ZIA-UR-RAHMAN

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